

POLICY NAME	Risk Management Policy
VERSION	1.0
DESCRIPTION	Ensure Risk Assessment and Risk Treatment
AUTHOR	Risk Officer
OWNER	Board of Trustees
DATE	18 th July, 2026
REVIEW FREQUENCY	At least annually

1. INTRODUCTION

Meridian Charity is a mental health and bereavement support charity located in Ashfield, London and was established in 2018. The charity provides emotional support, funeral assistance, bereavement counselling, wellbeing events and community services to individuals and families.

The charity is funded by donors and its work involves handling sensitive personal information of vulnerable individuals and also managing charitable funds.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to set out principles to ensure that Meridian Charity makes commitment to identify, assess, manage and reduce risk that could affect the safety of beneficiaries, Partners, staffs, volunteers, business operation, organizations reputation and the charity's ability to achieve its objectives.

This Policy provides a comprehensive framework to ensure risk are managed effectively across all the organizations operations.

3. Scope of Policy

This policy applies to Board of Trustees, CEO and Senior Management Team, All Staff and Volunteers, Partner Organizations, all Charity operations (Fundraising, Community events, emotional support services, etc).

4. Meridian Charity's Approach to Risk Management

The following principal outline Meridian's approach to risk management:

- Identify risks before starting activities, new programs or projects
- Assess the likelihood and potential impact of risks
- Take appropriate action to prevent or reduce risks to an appropriate standard.
- Monitor key risk on a regular basis.
- Maintain clear records of identified risks and actions taken
- All Staff/Volunteers are responsible for encouraging good risk management practices/ culture within their areas of work.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

5.1 Board of Trustees: They have a legal obligation to ensure risks within the organization are appropriately managed.

- Set the level of risk appetite and risk tolerance for the organization
- Approve major decisions affecting risk profile or exposure
- Receive regular reports on key risk and their mitigation also making risk informed decision.
- Ensuring appropriate controls and resources are available.
- Monitor and review major risk facing the charity.

5.2 The CEO and Senior Management Team: The CEO and Senior Management Team are responsible for:

- Overall Governance and risk oversight.
- Approving this policy
- Ensure that risk management policy is implemented throughout the organisation.
- Provide regular and timely information to the trustees on the status of risk and their mitigation.

5.3 Staff and Volunteers

All staff and volunteers have a role in:

- Safeguarding the resources for which they are responsible
- Maintaining risk awareness, Identifying and reporting risks, incidents, and safeguarding concerns immediately to their line Manager or Safeguarding Lead
- Follow charity policies, procedures including the Privacy Policy and Safeguarding Policy.

6 Risk Appetite Statement

Risk appetite is the amount and type of risk that an organisation is willing to accept while achieving its objectives.

- The charity has low risk appetite for any risk that could compromise the safety and wellbeing of beneficiaries, volunteers, or donors.
- The charity has no tolerance for safeguarding breaches, data protection violations or non compliance with regulatory requirements.
- The Charity utilizes 5 x 5 risk matrix and the risk appetite threshold is established at a score of 9. Any residual risk above the charity's risk appetite threshold are classified as unacceptable and mandatory risk treatment plans must be implemented to reduce the risk to an acceptable level.
- The Charity recognizes that a moderate level of operational risk may be accepted where it supports the delivery of its service, provided appropriate controls are implemented and monitored.
- The risk appetite statement is reviewed annually by the Board of Trustees

7. Risk Management Framework

7.1 Risk Identification

Risk will be Identified through regular risk assessment, Incident reporting, feedback from beneficiaries and stakeholders. Identifying those risk which are most likely to impact on the Charity's performance and delivery of services. Risk which Meridian Charity is exposed to are categorized into the following.

- Event Risks – Risks associated with charity events, workshops, and community activities.
- Safeguarding – Risks to the safety and wellbeing of beneficiaries, volunteers and vulnerable people.
- Financial and Funding Risks – Risks relating to donations, grant, budgeting and fraud.
- Operational and Programme Risks – Risks affecting the day to day running of services and programmes.
- Information and Data Security Risks – Risks involving personal data GDPR compliance and information security.
- Third Party and Partnership Risks – Risks arising from suppliers, partner organisations, contractors or service providers.
- Compliance and Legal Risks – Risks relating to laws, regulations, contractual obligations and required standard.

7.2 Risk Assessment

Identified risk would be assessed based on likelihood and impact to determine the level of risk.

- Likelihood – The probability that the risk will occur
- Impact – The loss or damage that the risk could cause if it happens

Risk would be prioritized according to their Risk level such as :

Low risk

Medium risk

High risk

7.3 Risk Mitigation

For each Identified risk, the charity will implement appropriate controls and strategies for mitigation and this would be documented in the risk register. Mitigation plans will be assigned to responsible individuals with clear timelines.

8 Reporting and Communication

- Communicate policy to staff / Volunteers and relevant parties
- A risk Register will be maintained. The Risk Officer will conduct an annual review of the Charity's operations to determine whether any new risk exist and if so, to have them recorded in the risk register.
- Meridian's Charity will describe steps it has taken to manage risk in its annual report. This is to demonstrate the charity's accountability to its stakeholders, including beneficiaries, donors, funders and the general public.

9. Review and Continuous Improvement

- The policy will be reviewed annually.

- The outcomes of the review will be reported to the Board of Trustees for consideration and continuous improvement of the risk management at Meridian's Charity.
- Internal Audit will be conducted as required to provide an independent assessment of the effectiveness of the charity's risk management policy, processes and procedures and to evaluate how consistently they are implemented across the organisation. The findings will be reported to the Board of Trustees and relevant senior management to support effective governance and continuous improvement of the charity's risk management framework.
- Policies will align with changes in:
Identification of new risk in the charity's operations/activities
Regulatory requirement

10. Non Compliance and Consequences of Policy Violation

Meridian Charity expects all trustees, staff/volunteers and all relevant parties to comply with this risk management policy. Violation of this policy shall be considered grounds for disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Additional Information
V1.0	July, 2026	Risk Officer	